

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa confirmed to entering the Schengen area

2-4 weeks before departure

- Check your visa sticker: validity dates, number of entries permitted, and that your passport details match
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your travel dates - at least 3 months beyond your planned departure from the Schengen area
- Confirm flights and accommodation for every night of your trip
- Keep your travel medical insurance certificate accessible - it can be checked at the border
- Notify your bank/card providers of your travel dates and destination(s)

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa page, flight itinerary, accommodation confirmation, insurance certificate, and any invitation/sponsor declaration
- Reconfirm your day-by-day itinerary if visiting multiple Schengen countries - keep it consistent with what you applied with
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time for an international departure
- Keep your passport and printed documents in your hand luggage

At the Schengen border

A visa doesn't automatically grant entry - a border guard makes the final decision at your first point of entry into the Schengen area, and can ask questions consistent with your application. This is routine, not a sign of a problem.

- Be ready to show your return/onward ticket, accommodation proof, insurance certificate, and financial evidence if asked
- Your entry and exit dates are stamped or recorded - keep track of your 90/180-day allowance across the whole Schengen area, not per country
- Overstaying, even in a different Schengen country from where you entered, is tracked against your total allowance